

```
$ whoami --security-professional
```

LINUX COMMANDS EVERY SECURITY PRO SHOULD KNOW

A field guide across 8 categories —
navigation to privilege escalation.



bash

```
$ ss -tlnp
```

show listening ports

```
$ sudo -l
```

check my sudo rights

```
$ journalctl -xe
```

read the system journal

swipe →

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NAVIGATION & FILES



find.sh

\$ ls -la

list all files, incl. hidden

\$ find / -name "x"

search the whole filesystem

\$ find / -perm -4000

find SUID binaries

\$ file suspicious

identify a file's true type

\$ which command

locate a binary's path

PERMISSIONS & OWNERSHIP



chmod.sh

\$ chmod 755 file
set read/write/execute bits

\$ chown user:group f
change file ownership

\$ chmod u+s file
set SUID bit — privesc-relevant

\$ getfacl file
view access control list

USERS, GROUPS & AUTH



whoami.sh

\$ whoami / id

who am I, what groups am I in

\$ sudo -l

what can I run as root?

\$ cat /etc/passwd

list all accounts on the box

\$ last / lastb

login history / failed logins

PROCESSES & SERVICES



ps.sh

```
$ ps aux --sort=-%cpu
```

top CPU-consuming processes

```
$ pstree
```

parent-child process tree

```
$ systemctl status <svc>
```

check a service's state

```
$ crontab -l
```

list scheduled jobs

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NETWORKING



net.sh

\$ ip a

interfaces & IP addresses

\$ ss -tulnp

listening ports + owning process

\$ nmap -sV -p- target

port/service scan — authorized targets only

\$ tcpdump -i eth0 port 80

live packet capture

LOGGING & MONITORING



logs.sh

\$ journalctl -xe

systemd journal with context

\$ tail -f /var/log/auth.log

live authentication log

\$ grep "Failed password" auth.log | wc -l

quick brute-force check

\$ dmesg

kernel ring buffer messages

PRIVILEGE ESCALATION ENUM



privesc.sh

\$ sudo -l

what can I already run as root?

\$ find / -perm -4000 -type f

hunt SUID binaries

\$ find / -writable -type d

world-writable directories

\$ uname -a

kernel version vs known CVEs

■ Practice in an isolated lab — never on production.

MALWARE TRIAGE & INTEGRITY



triage.sh

\$ sha256sum file

fingerprint / verify a file

\$ strings binary | grep -i http

hunt IOCs inside a binary

\$ strace ./binary

trace system calls

\$ lsof -i

list open network connections

■ Practice in an isolated lab — never on production.

```
$ echo "that's a wrap"
```

KEEP THIS IN YOUR BACK POCKET



next_steps.sh

- Practice in a home lab, not production.
- Start with sections 1-4 until they're muscle memory.
- Save this post for your next terminal session.

Follow for more Linux + cybersecurity breakdowns